

The previous chapter dealt with the contemporary applications offered by mobile phones. The range of services and applications has grown over the last decade as mobile companies have integrated a large number of services to keep customers within their fold. From simple text messaging, companies today offer services such as Internet browsing and music and video playback. Many of these services are supported by newer models, but are entirely contingent on the service providers.

With the increased connectivity between the mobile world and the Internet, newer applications are sprouting. Applications that straddle these two domains are fast becoming *de rigueur*. Protocols such as WAP and tools on the Internet such as Skype have played a large role in bridging these seemingly diverse channels. Connectivity via Bluetooth and infrared has resulted in applications on mobile phones that let you control household devices such as the refrigerator, washing machines and air conditioners. This “Extended Internet” is the new driving force behind the mobile boom.

Ease of use for the consumer and a device that acts as a one point node for any human to log onto this X-Internet is what the mobile phone provides.

Among the newer applications that are being developed or in use, a few such as mobile blogging, and mobile wallets, can be operated by most mobile phones and services. Others such as RFID and GPS-enabled phones are targeted at a smaller section of the market as they are very specific utility related phones.